

Michael Panzarella

CEO & FOUNDER, ARCCENTRX

Former COO & CPO, Rocket Dollar · Deposit Operations Lead, Square Financial Services · CPO/CDO, Green Dot



He was building recommendation engines for HP and Best Buy in the late nineties. Then he spent the next two decades inside regulated finance, where shipping AI is a different sport.

Mike has sat in the COO, CFO, and CPO chairs across three decades of banking, fintech, and technology, and he was building AI-driven product tools before the category had a name. He has directed more than \$2.1 billion in banking, technology, and consumer-retail initiatives spanning product strategy, regulatory compliance, operational delivery, and M&A execution. He launched a de novo bank charter at Square, ran operations and product at Rocket Dollar from early stage through its acquisition, and has built delivery organizations across North America, Europe, and the Middle East. He now leads ArcCentrx, an advisory and management consulting firm working with mid-size companies on the operating problems that never make the board deck.

30+

YEARS IN BANKING,
FINTECH, AND TECH

\$2.1B

IN INITIATIVES
DIRECTED

14 MO.

FILING TO A LIVE BANK
CHARTER AT SQUARE

\$1B

SCALED AT ROCKET
DOLLAR, THEN AN EXIT

WHAT HE TALKS ABOUT

AI that survives a compliance review

Early configuration and recommendation tools for HP, Cisco, Gateway, and Best Buy, and what changes when the same ideas meet FDIC and CFPB oversight.

Standing up a bank from zero

Square's ILC charter end to end: regulatory frameworks, FDIC and Utah DFI coordination, Federal Reserve integration, operational in 14 months.

Scaling to \$1B, then selling the company

Co-leading Rocket Dollar's A round, growth to \$1B in alternative-investment assets under administration, and running the M&A exit.

Consumer fintech at volume

Green Dot from 4M to 6M active customers across 11 brands and 31 products. Launched Apple Pay Cash and Uber's business debit card.

Why transformation stalls

What he sees advising mid-size companies now, and why the visible problem is rarely the real constraint.

GOOD ON A SHOW

Talks about regulated finance without hiding behind jargon.

Brings dates, numbers, and named products rather than generalities.

Has run the company and advised the company, so he will say what went wrong.

Advised the Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta on IT governance and Square Financial Services pre-charter.

Equally at home with a startup, Fortune 500, or regulated-bank audience. Remote or in studio.

SIX QUESTIONS TO OPEN WITH

01 You shipped recommendation engines for HP and Best Buy in the late nineties. What does that era teach us about AI now?

02 Square went from charter filing to a live bank in 14 months. What would have killed it?

03 Rocket Dollar reached \$1B in assets with a small team. Where did the real advantage come from?

04 You ran the sale of a company you helped build. What do founders misjudge about their own exit?

05 Green Dot served 6M customers across 31 products. What breaks at that scale?

06 You have held the CFO, COO, and CPO seats. Which one shows first that a company is in trouble?